

MIQUEL BARBARÀ

Game Designer — Technical Background

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Game design leader with hands-on programming experience, currently designing enemy behavior and environmental systems for a cooperative hack-and-slash built on a custom C++/DirectX12 engine. Comfortable owning design problems end-to-end — from player insight and playtesting to implementation-ready specs — and communicating clearly across engineering, art, and production. Drawn to live-service, systems-driven design after seeing firsthand how iteration and player feedback shape a game.

PROJECTS

Design Lead — Cooperative Hack-and-Slash (Master's Project)

2025 – Present

Talent School – UPC | Project blog: ravenwhisp.github.io/Ravenwhisp/blog

- Leading design for a 7-person design team within an 18-person project building an isometric co-op hack-and-slash (Diablo III / Torchlight-inspired aesthetic) on a custom C++/DirectX12 engine built in parallel.
- Own design of enemy behavior and environmental trap systems, balancing challenge and pacing for cooperative play.
- Ran 5 structured playtesting and feedback sessions, using player insight to identify pain points and drive iteration on mechanics.
- Analyze the current state of the game against design goals, then plan and lead team meetings to align designers around a shared direction and surface new feature ideas.
- Partner directly with the engine/gameplay programming team to keep design proposals grounded in technical feasibility and implementation-ready.
- Beyond the design lead role, contribute directly to engine programming: implemented the asset system, worked on D3D12 graphics architecture, and built a quadtree implementation for spatial partitioning.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Design & Programming Intern

February 2026 – June 2026 (4 months)

Flykube, Barcelona, Spain

- Interned for 4 months building a prototype mobile game in Unity.
- Personally programmed gameplay systems and mechanics for the prototype.

Teaching Assistant

September 2022 – June 2025

La Salle Barcelona, Barcelona, Spain

- Taught SQL and NoSQL database design to undergraduate students, building clear technical communication skills.
- Developed algorithm-based coursework projects covering probability and data handling.

Junior Developer

July 2025 – September 2025

Netix, Reus, Spain

- Built a booking system with calendar integration, gathering functional requirements directly from stakeholders.
- Worked with production code under real deadlines as part of a small team.

EDUCATION

Advanced Programming for AAA Video Games

2025 – 2026

Talent School, UPC

Multimedia Engineer (Videogame Mention)

2021 – 2025

La Salle Ramon Llull

LANGUAGES & TECHNOLOGIES

Design: Systems and mechanics design, enemy/encounter design, balancing and pacing, playtesting and iteration, design documentation and specs

Technical: C++ (STL, OOP, memory management), C# (gameplay/tooling), engine architecture fundamentals (DirectX12, asset systems, quadtrees), Git

Languages spoken: Catalan (native), Spanish (native), English (fluent)